

Clie Power

At last, a Palm reply to the Pocket PC! The Sony Clie PDA series features all that the Pocket PC had on offer—colour screens, built-in MP3 player, 8- and 16-bit colour playback, resolutions of 160x160 and 320x320...

First in the range is the PEG-N710C. It features a built-in MP3 player with headphones, Palm OS 3.5, resolution of 320x320 and 8-bit colour. It comes with an 8 MB Memory Stick as standard, which lets you store tracks. You can add a larger Memory Stick of 8, 16, 32, 64 or 128 MB.

The other models in the range do not have MP3 playback, but come with high graphic capabilities. The PEG-N610C/S or the PEG-N610C/V is powered by the latest Palm OS 4.0 and has 320x320 resolution along with 16-bit colour.



Sony Clie N710C:
MP3 on your Palm

Installing Windows Media Player 7.1

Download the wmnall.exe setup file into your PC. Make sure that ActiveSync is running and that your Pocket PC is connected to the PC. Before starting the installation, make sure that the Pocket PC does not have any previous versions of Windows Media Player installed in your machine. If you have an older version, make sure that it is uninstalled before continuing with the installation.

Double-click on the wmnall.exe file to start the installation process.

Click on the Yes button to continue with the installation.



Copying a media file to a Pocket PC to play video

Settings > Audio & Video in the Windows Media Player 7.1. Select Yes from the Audio and the Video drop-down menus. A message pops up, warning of delays and device instability. Click OK; this ought to set the problem right. There you are! Your Pocket PC is now fully equipped to play all your movies and music videos.

You can also play video clips on a Palm. Some of the video player software available for the Palm are gMovie Player, FireViewer, Teal-Movie, etc. Let's take a look at how to use gMovie Player for playing video clips.

First of all, download gMovie Player 2.0 from www.genericmedia.com. Unzip the file and install using Palm Desktop. Use the HotSync manager to add gMovie Player to the HotSync list. Synchronising between your Palm and PC will install gMovie Player.

You will need to install gMovie Maker 2.0 (available from the site) on your PC to convert QuickTime, AVI, and MPEG-1 files to the gMovie format for playback on the gMovie Player.

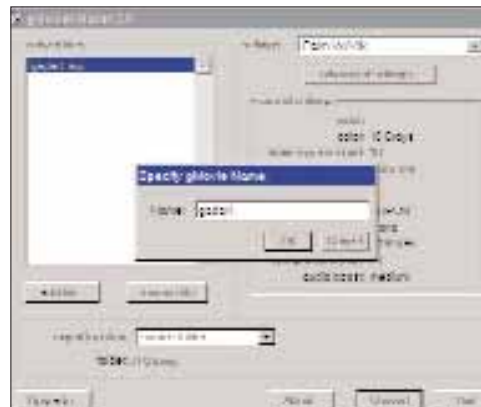
To convert video files into the gMovie format, using gMovie Maker, make sure that you have QuickTime 5, with the QuickTime authoring component.

To convert the media clips, click on the Add File button on the gMovie Maker interface to add the file to be converted. Now use the Convert button to start conversion of the file. It will be saved as a .pdb file in the source directory unless you specify otherwise.

Copy the .pdb file into the Palm using the Palm Desktop. By tapping on the file you can watch the video clip using gMovie Player.



Video clips on the Palm



Using gMovie Maker to convert media clips

Are you game?

Installing games on the Pocket PC is very simple. First check your device's specifications to see whether you have the correct processor type for your Pocket PC. Once you have figured out which file is perfect, just download it into your PC.

Many games come with set up programs that can be installed straight from your PC's desktop. Some have self-extractor files. Clicking on the file will extract the file into your PC. Make sure that ActiveSync is on and that your Pocket PC is connected, since some files self-extract and install themselves directly. In other cases, the file will be extracted into some folder on your PC. If it is a .exe or .com file, simply copy it into your device and run it from there.

Some games come in compressed formats such as .zip and .rar. Use utilities such as WinZip and WinRAR to extract these files. Most of the files will have Read Me files in which the directions for installing will be given. In case only an exe file or com file is there, then just copy it into the Pocket PC and run it from there.

Games are also available as .cab files. Get hold of the file appropriate for your PDA's processor and copy it into the device. Now use File Explorer in your Pocket PC to go to the folder where the file has been placed. Tap on the file to get it running.

Installing games on the Palm is really easy. Most of the game files that are downloaded have the .prc extension. Some of the games may also have .pdb extensions. To install these files on to your Palm from the PC, start the Palm Desktop. Click on Install, browse for the file you want to install and then click on the Add button. The next time you do a HotSync, all these files will be installed automatically. You can now start the game by simply tapping on it.

So what are you waiting for? Get down to where the action is. 🎮